

R22 COMMONLY CONFUSED WORDS

Some words in English sound the same or very similar, but mean different things. It is essential to spell the words correctly to achieve the correct meaning in a sentence.

accept / except

I **accept** your apology.
Everyone was on the list **except** for me.

adverse / averse

She was feeling unwell due to the **adverse** effects of her medication.
He was lazy and **averse** to playing sport.

aisle / isle

The bride walked down the **aisle**.
They visited an **isle** near the coast of Scotland.

aloud / allowed

She read the book **aloud**.
He was **allowed** to choose which book to read.

amoral / immoral

Her **amoral** attitude meant that she didn't care if her actions were wrong.
He was fired from the firm for **immoral** conduct.

appraise / apprise

The manager needed to **appraise** the employee's skills.
The lawyer **apprised** the defendant of his rights.

assent / ascent

He nodded his **assent**.
They watched the **ascent** of the balloon.

aural / oral

The **aural** test required her to listen.
The dentist performed an **oral** examination.

bare / bear

The trees were stripped **bare**.
The large **bear** roamed the woods.

break / brake

The chocolate was easy to **break** apart.
The car didn't **brake** fast enough.

broach / brooch

He decided to **broach** the subject for discussion.
She wore a pretty **brooch**.

cereal / serial

He ate a bowl of **cereal** for breakfast.
She found the **serial** number on her computer.

complement / compliment

The colors **complement** each other well.
He paid her a **compliment** by telling her she was pretty.

cue / queue

The actor waited for his **cue** before walking on stage.
The checkout **queue** was very long.

desert / dessert

The **desert** is extremely hot and dry.
She decided to have cake for **dessert**.

draught / draft

There was a **draught** coming from under the door.
He had written a **draft** of the letter.

pore / pour

I could see every **pore** on his nose.
She helped **pour** the drinks at the party.

principle / principal

The man believed in strong **principles**.
He was given the role of the **principal** character.

stationary / stationery

The aircraft landed and remained **stationary**.
She looked in the **stationery** cupboard for a pen.